

Laser Printers

Continuing from last month's mono laser test, here are the ones that lie in the mid-range

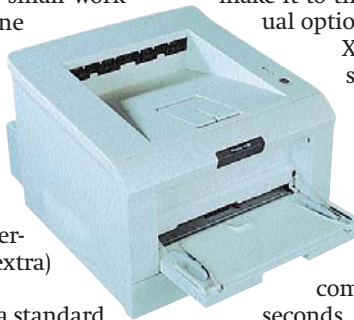
Xerox Phaser 3120

Vanilla anyone?

The Xerox Phaser 3120 is a typical, vanilla design laser printer box that better suits the back office.

Touted as a personal or small work-group laser, this machine doesn't boast of cutting edge features. There is only one button on the printer and two indicators for indicating paper jam and online/offline. The Phaser 3120 connects to a PC via either USB or parallel interface; you have to opt (pay extra) for the network interface.

The printer comes with a standard 250-sheet input paper tray and a 150-sheet output tray. An optional paper tray is available to augment the paper capacity by another 250 sheets—good enough for a small work group. The manual feeder has a capacity of 50 sheets, and that's much better than the sheet feeders most lasers have today.



Installation was a breeze; the toner cartridge slides down in position without any problems. Driver installation took five minutes; the driver interface is nothing fancy—simple to understand and functional. Auto duplexing doesn't make it to this printer, but a manual option exists.

Xerox claims a 22 PPM speed; we got around 18 PPM, which isn't that bad. The first page takes around 11 seconds to print and that's what most laser printers in this class deliver. Our combi-document took 22 seconds to print, which isn't quite up to the mark. In contrast, the photo-target image took 23 seconds to complete despite its complexity. Of course, the combi-document is 35 MB in size and any heavy file will take longer to print on this printer.

Prints lack vibrancy and look dull, and the problem seems to be a low

density of toner being deposited on the paper. Thus, some banding occurred in the greyscale test.

The toner cartridge is rated to deliver 3500 pages and costs Rs 6,400, giving us an indicative cost per page of Rs 1.83—expensive. Xerox does provide an option to upgrade to a higher yield cartridge rated to deliver 5000 pages.

The Xerox Phaser 3120 has an MRP of Rs 17,000—expensive; we suggest you skip this printer.

Specifications

22 PPM, 166 MHz processor, buffer memory 32 MB upgradeable to 144 MB, 600 dpi resolution, USB & parallel interface and 250 sheets output tray.

Price: Rs 17,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★○
Print Speed	★★★★○
Print Quality	★★★★○
Value for money	★★★★○
Overall	★★★★○

HP LaserJet 1022n

Good for small loads

The LaserJet 1022n is a networked version of the base model LJ-1022 and is aimed at those looking for a network printer for a small workgroups. The design is refreshing, and should fit the décor of any modern office.

The LJ-1022n sports a vertical profile design that uses less desk space. This design looks great, but the paper tray juts out of the body. Also, the translucent flap sits over the input paper tray and a mere push unsettles it.

The front panel on the LJ-1022n has two buttons and three LEDs to indicate various errors. This printer comes with a 250-sheet input tray with no option to increase the paper capacity via additional trays. The 150-sheet output tray is quite flimsy. The LJ-1022n has both a USB as well as a network interface.

Installing the printer was as simple as it gets. The driver interface is neat and clean, simple to understand and feature

rich. Installing the printer over the network didn't take much effort—the driver detected the network

printer immediately. The Web administration panel is very configurable and gives greater control over the printer. Anyone with moderate technical skills can setup this printer on a network.

The LJ-1022n fell short of the claimed 18 PPM by just a page. The first page takes 8 seconds to print. The combi-document took 8 and 9 seconds respectively for normal and best settings. The photo file was printed in 9 seconds.

Quality was crisp and dark. Finer details were reproduced exactly and reversed text was completely legible. Some banding was seen in the grey scale gradation test, but text was reproduced without any spread or jaggedness.



At 2000 pages per cartridge, at Rs 2950, the cost per page is Rs 1.48.

The LaserJet 1022n is priced at Rs 15,999—good value for money considering its performance, above average quality and the network option. Overall, a good laser printer for small workgroups with light printing loads.

Specifications

18 PPM, 266 MHz processor, 8 MB memory, 250 Sheet input tray, 150 sheet output tray, USB 2.0 and HP JetDirect Printer server.

Price: Rs 15,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★○
Print Speed	★★★★○
Print Quality	★★★★○
Value for money	★★★★○
Overall	★★★★○



Samsung ML-4551ND, ML-3051ND & ML-3561ND

World Class Samsung Network Laser Printers

ML-4551ND: 43ppm • Duplex • Network
 ML-3051ND: 28ppm • Duplex • Network
 ML-3561ND: 33ppm • Duplex • Network

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 Chennai: 9845291777, 9845158871 • Bangalore: 9845291772